



March 15, 2025

[Sent electronically to [REDACTED]]
AI Action Plan
Attn: Faisal D'Souza, NCO
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

RE: Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

ASHP (American Society of Health-System Pharmacists) is pleased to submit comments¹ on the AI Intelligence Action Plan. ASHP is the largest association of pharmacy professionals in the United States, representing 60,000 pharmacists, student pharmacists, and pharmacy technicians in all patient care settings, including hospitals, ambulatory clinics, and health-system community pharmacies. For over 80 years, ASHP has championed innovation in pharmacy practice, advanced education and professional development, and served as a steadfast advocate for members and patients.

ASHP recognizes AI's potential to enhance patient care and the medication-use process. AI can contribute by improving data collection for clinical, operational, and economic insights, supporting end users, enriching education, and optimizing administrative workflows within pharmacy practice. Pharmacists are uniquely positioned to lead AI adoption in healthcare by ensuring safe, effective, and ethical implementation of AI technologies. To maximize AI benefits, it is critical that pharmacists and other healthcare professionals play a central role in AI model validation, governance, and patient safety assurance.

ASHP has committed significant resources to evaluating AI's implications² for patient care, pharmacy practice, and our nation's healthcare system. In June 2024, the ASHP AI Summit³ convened pharmacy leaders, informaticists, and healthcare experts to examine the potential of AI and to consider the potential challenges to appropriate use of AI. Key takeaways from the Summit emphasized that:

- AI should be seamlessly integrated into healthcare to enhance decision-making, patient safety, and operational efficiency—not as a replacement for clinical expertise but as a tool to support and elevate healthcare professionals.
- Building trust in AI-driven healthcare solutions requires transparent validation, continuous monitoring, and safeguards that prioritize accuracy, reliability, and patient access to all Americans, while fostering innovation.
- Health systems should be encouraged to invest in AI-ready infrastructure, workforce planning, and governance models to ensure safe and effective implementation while maintaining flexibility for emerging advancements.

¹ This document is approved for public dissemination. The document contains no business-proprietary or confidential information. Document contents may be reused by the government in developing the AI Action Plan and associated documents without attribution.

² See ASHP Statement on Artificial Intelligence in Pharmacy, [artificial-intelligence-in-pharmacy.ashx](https://www.ashp.org/artificial-intelligence-in-pharmacy).

³ See [Pharmacy Futures: Summit on Artificial Intelligence in Pharmacy Practice | American Journal of Health-System Pharmacy | Oxford Academic](https://www.ashp.org/pharmacy-futures-summit-on-artificial-intelligence-in-pharmacy-practice).

- A skilled healthcare workforce is essential for maximizing AI's potential, requiring expanded education and training initiatives to equip pharmacists and other healthcare professionals with the knowledge to evaluate, implement, and manage AI tools responsibly.
- Pharmacists, as medication experts, should play a key role in AI development, deployment, and oversight, ensuring AI solutions strengthen medication safety, clinical decision support, and patient-centered care.

As AI innovation progresses, pharmacy and medication-use processes present a high-impact opportunity to improve patient care, medication safety, and healthcare efficiency. To strengthen our nation's leadership in AI-driven healthcare innovation, we recommend the following tenets that can help accelerate and guide AI adoption in pharmacy and the medication-use process:

- **Pharmacy Leadership in AI Decision-Making:** Pharmacists should be actively engaged in AI development and governance, to ensure that AI technologies enhance medication safety, clinical decision support, and operational efficiency. AI tools that support medication prescribing, dispensing, and monitoring should align with evidence-based guidelines, industry best practices, and regulatory standards that serve and protect patients and optimize patient outcomes.
- **Ensure that AI Supports, Not Replaces, Clinicians' Medical Decision-Making Authority:** AI-powered tools can improve medication safety through real-time adverse drug event detection, drug interaction screening, and pharmacovigilance. However, pharmacists and clinicians should retain decision-making authority to mitigate potential risks of AI drift or over-reliance on AI. Pharmacists should be involved in ongoing monitoring and quality assurance to mitigate these risks.
- **Transparency and Validation are Key to AI Adoption in Healthcare:** Confidence in innovative AI-driven healthcare solutions requires clear and transparent validation processes. AI tools used in the medication-use process should be evaluated for accuracy, reliability, and safety, using best practices that ensure patient protection while fostering innovation. This process should include model validation, transparency, and auditing before use in patient care. Further, AI-driven pharmacy systems should be interoperable with electronic health records and other healthcare technologies, to support seamless integration into existing healthcare flows.
- **Expand AI Training for Pharmacists and Healthcare Professionals:** A well-trained workforce is essential to ensuring AI's timely and responsible adoption. The healthcare workforce should have access to training on data science fundamentals, AI ethics, generative AI applications in healthcare, and AI model validation and risk management. Expanding incentives and investment in AI-focused pharmacy residency programs, training, pharmacist-led AI research, and workforce development will strengthen the nation's AI capabilities ensuring that AI applications are safe and effective for patients.
- **Empower the Pharmacy Workforce Through AI Innovation:** AI has the potential to enhance healthcare operational efficiency through improved inventory management, medication adherence tracking, and supply chain optimization. AI should be leveraged to free pharmacists from routine administrative tasks, allowing them to focus on essential, high-value clinical services that improve patient outcomes. However, pharmacists must ensure AI-driven automation does not compromise patient safety and

privacy, medication access, or workflow efficiency. As AI technologies advance, collaboration between healthcare leaders, industry partners, and policymakers will be critical to ensure that workforce training keeps pace with AI integration and that the healthcare workforce is strengthened.

- **Build Strong AI Accountability, Reliability, and Safety:** To maintain trust in AI-driven healthcare solutions, healthcare organizations (including, but not limited to, pharmacies, physician clinics, insurers, hospitals and health systems) should establish AI governance models, best practices for AI oversight, and contingency plans for AI system malfunctions, model failures, cybersecurity threats, system downtime, and data integrity challenges. Clinicians, including pharmacists and pharmacy technicians, should be actively involved in defining fallback procedures to protect patient safety and maintain care continuity in the event of AI system malfunctions.

As work progresses on the AI Action Plan, ASHP stands ready to serve as a partner and resource on AI-driven healthcare innovation. We support efforts to integrate AI in healthcare in a safe, effective, and minimally disruptive manner. Given the unique challenges and opportunities accompanying AI-driven healthcare technologies, we encourage the administration to convene meetings with healthcare providers and other key stakeholders to establish consistent national AI adoption standards. Please do not hesitate to contact me at [REDACTED] or [REDACTED] if ASHP can provide any further information or assist the administration in any way.

Sincerely,

Jillanne Schulte Wall, J.D.
Senior Director, Health & Regulatory Policy